



Ancient Buildings of Wudang Mountains

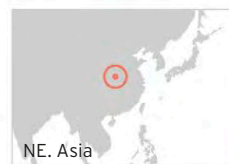
A vast, ancient architectural complex in a spectacular location and one of the world's most important Taoist centers

The complex on the Wudang Mountains in central China forms an important part of the country's religious and cultural landscape. While some buildings on the site date to the reign of the Tang dynasty Emperor Taizong (r.629–649 CE), the area was most fully developed as a complex during the Ming dynasty (14th–17th centuries), with expansions in the late 17th and early 19th centuries.

Blending into the landscape

The vast site features spectacular examples of Chinese art and architecture, including numerous palaces, monasteries, and temples, all of which

harmonize with the breathtaking natural environment, with its 72 peaks and various valleys, streams, caves, and ponds. Among the most important and impressive of the Wudang structures is the wooden Purple Heaven Palace, or Zixiao Palace, constructed during the 12th century, rebuilt in the 15th century, and expanded in the 19th century. Other notable buildings at Wudang include the Golden Shrine and the Ancient Bronze Shrine, both early 14th-century buildings in bronze; the Nanyang Palace (12th–13th centuries); and the Fuzhen Temple (15th and 17th centuries).



MOUNTAIN PALACE

The Purple Heaven Palace is spread over about 73,800 square ft (6,850 square m) and comprises 182 rooms laid out symmetrically. It rises from the Dragon and Tiger Hall, through the Great Hall (built for the worship of the deity Zhenwu), to the Parents' Hall. The Great Hall is among the most distinctive wooden structures at Wudang.

